

who sustained a cheekbone injury in April, and defender Gvardiol, who returned to action after a five-month lay-off due to a tibial fracture, can hit the ground running.

In its World Cup debut in 2018, Panama was the worst-performing nation, with three defeats and having shipped 11 goals. Under Thomas Christiansen, Panama has made a steady progression in the last four years, which includes a CONCACAF Nations League final appearance last year. Christiansen will be hoping that key midfielder Adalberto Carrasquilla, who suffered a pull to his left adductor, will be fully fit for the tournament. Though the conditions might be familiar to the North American nation, only a strong start in the group opener against Ghana might aid in an outside chance of making it into the round of 32.

Despite the ignominy of failing to qualify for the AFCON finals earlier this year, Ghana was among the beneficiaries of the expanded World Cup, which increased Africa's allocation from five to nine spots. While the Black Stars possess quality in Antoine Semenyo, Thomas Partey and Iñaki Williams, it may still not be enough to leave a significant mark on the biggest stage.



Adalberto Carrasquilla (Panama)

Carrasquilla is hard to miss with his curly hair bouncing around the pitch, but it is his quality on the ball that truly stands out. The attacking midfielder has the vision and passing range to unlock defences.



Antoine Semenyo (Ghana)

While Semenyo has yet to fully translate his club form to the national side, the wide forward comes into the tournament after scoring 21 goals for both AFC Bournemouth and Manchester City F.C. this season. His pace and two-footed finishing make him a nightmare for defenders.

SQUADS

England

Goalkeepers: Jordan Pickford, Dean Henderson, James Trafford

Defenders: Djed Spence, Marc Guéhi, Ezri Konsa, Reece James, Nico O'Reilly, Tino Livramento, Jarell Quansah, John Stones, Dan Burn

Midfielders: Eberechi Eze, Declan Rice, Elliot Anderson, Jude Bellingham, Morgan Rogers, Kobbie Mainoo, Jordan Henderson

Forwards: Harry Kane, Bukayo Saka, Noni Madueke, Anthony Gordon, Ollie Watkins, Ivan Toney, Marcus Rashford

Croatia

Goalkeepers: Dominik Livaković, Dominik Kotarski, Ivor Pandur

Defenders: Joško Gvardiol, Duje Ćaleta-Car, Josip Šutalo, Josip Stanišić, Marin Pongračić, Martin Erlić, Luka Vušković

Midfielders: Luka Modrić, Mateo Kovačić, Mario Pašalić, Nikola Vlašić, Luka Sučić, Martin Baturina, Kristijan Jakić, Petar Sučić, Nikola Moro, Toni Fruk

Forwards: Ivan Perišić, Andrej Kramarić, Ante Budimir, Marco Pašalić, Petar Musa, Igor Matanović

Panama

Goalkeepers: Orlando Mosquera, Luis Mejia, Cesar Samudio

Defenders: Cesar Blackman, Jorge Gutierrez, Amir Murillo, Fidel Escobar, Andres Andrade, Edgardo Farina, Jose Cordoba, Eric Davis, Jiovany Ramos, Roderick Miller

Midfielders: Anibal Godoy, Adalberto Carrasquilla, Carlos Harvey, Cristian Martinez, Jose Luis Rodriguez, Cesar Yanis, Yoel Barcenas, Alberto Quintero, Azarias Londono

Forwards: Ismael Diaz, Cecilio Waterman, Jose Fajardo, Tomas Rodriguez

Ghana

Goalkeepers: Benjamin Asare, Lawrence Ati-Zigi, Joseph Anang

Defenders: Baba Abdul Rahman, Gideon Mensah, Marvin Senaya, Alidu Seidu, Abdul Mumin, Jerome Opoku, Jonas Adjete, Kojo Peprah Oppong, Derrick Luckassen

Midfielders: Thomas Partey, Kwasi Sibbo, Augustine Boakye, Caleb Yirenkyi, Abdul Fatawu Issahaku, Elisha Owusu

Forwards: Kamaldeen Sulemana, Christopher Bonsu Baah, Ernest Nuamah, Antoine Semenyo, Brandon Thomas-Asante, Prince Kwabena Adu, Inaki Williams, Jordan Ayew